Project Update Report

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March 5, 2026

Original Vision Statement: I will gain a better understanding of myself as a job candidate and how I fit in the job market, have updated job search assets, complete technical interview practice, and be better connected to my local tech community.

Original Goals:	**Accomplishments**:
Continue moderating a Job Search Council (JSC) through the Never Search Alone (NSA) program, attend/lead all relevant JSC and moderator meetings, and keep members motivated via Slack	Moderated all JSC meetings (except the one today due to interview). Sent weekly Monday check-in to team to keep conversations flowing, and responded to all posts by team members.
Complete all NSA exercises, including the Mnookin 2 Pager, Listening Tour, and Candidate-Market Fit	Mnookin 2-Pager completed. One Listening Tour call completed; more needed. CMF not started yet.
Update experience log, resume and LinkedIn with recent job and CSPB experience, industry best-practices, and feedback from reviewers	7 STAR stories created, and over 15 additional stories drafted (need a little more fleshing out). Received resume feedback from Professor Guinn; I still need to update my resume. LinkedIn updates not started yet.
Hone my elevator pitch	Completed.
Look into Mock Interview services	Completed two mock interviews with ex-Amazon recruiter; still want to look into interviewing.io in more detail.
Attend one local tech Meetup per week	Attended 4 tech Meetups (Women in Tech event, AI, resume review, STAR story practice). This is below the targeted goal of one Meetup per week (short 2 events) due to time needed for interview preparation.
If time permitting: complete courses on TPM interviews, and possibly PMP exam prep	Not started.

Changes Made: I did not make any changes to the original project plan.

Reflections: This project has been extremely motivating to get ready for the job market. I have already learned a lot about myself as a job market candidate through the NSA process, the meetups I've attended and the rigorous process of preparing for the Amazon interviews.

At each of the Meetups I've attended, I've enjoyed meeting new people there, and am succeeding in feeling more connected to my local tech scene, including adding many new LinkedIn contacts.

This project has greatly helped me both feel more confident for the job search and prepare my job search assets. Moderating the JSC meetings put me into leader/project manager mode, which is a good state to be in when preparing for interviews. I now have my elevator pitch and many STAR stories, so I feel well-prepared for most interviews.

I have also been learning about the emotional journey of interview preparation, and what tools to use to manage stress during this process.

I want to continue with the remaining goals I have. In particular getting through more of the NSA exercises, fleshing out more of my STAR stories and adding some more technical oriented ones, updating my resume and LinkedIn, and getting back to attending weekly Meetups. I don't expect that I'll have time to work on PMP prep before the end of the semester, but who knows?! I'd like to get more interviews in my pipeline to continue practicing (depending on how the Amazon interview went).

I also learned a lot about the art of interviewing, how to try to decipher what the interview question is really asking, approaches to answering different types of questions, and the best format to answer to prove my abilities. I want to add more quantifyable metrics / results into my stories as well.